A Hand to Heal Him

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/63988120.

Rating:	Explicit
Archive Warning:	No Archive Warnings Apply
Category:	M/M
Fandom:	崩坏：星穹铁道 | Honkai: Star Rail (Video Game)
Relationship:	Mydei/Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)
Characters:	Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)
Additional Tags:	Top Phainon/Bottom Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Top Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Bottom Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Hurt/Comfort, Minor Injuries, Massage, Semi-Public Sex, Hand Jobs, Anal Fingering, Anal Sex
Language:	English
Stats:	Published: 2025-03-19 Words: 5,619 Chapters: 1/1

A Hand to Heal Him

by Malefícar

Summary

This time, Phainon doesn't tense, but he does say, "We're on the same side, but it's not as if you treat me like a friend." Mydei does, in fact, treat Phainon like a friend, but their expectations for friendship are clearly very, very different. "And now we're naked, in the baths, and you've got your hands half an inch from my dick."

"Are you always so preoccupied with the proximity of my hands to your dick?" Mydei asks. Phainon makes the same sort of sound you'd hear from a wet cat. Mydei choses to ignore it. "I'm not going to touch you anywhere but your leg."

Even though he wants to. Even though he's wanted to for quite a long time.

Phainon injures his leg while training, and Mydei tends to it.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Mydei watches Phainon limp toward the otherwise empty bath with thinly veiled disgust. "What have you done to yourself *this* time, Deliverer?" he asks, allowing his voice to drip with disdain.

Phainon barely regards him, wincing as he eases into the water and then groaning with relief as it swallows him to his waist. He sinks lower, settling on a ledge as he drapes his arms across the bath's tiled lip and tips back his head. "Training," he says.

Mydei isn't particularly surprised to hear this, even though it's late—far too late for any sane person to be awake, but with the eternal sunlight of the Dawn Device, Okhema knows no true night. All hours are ones that could be spent at work, and Phainon is nothing if not industrious in his refinement of his skills. And yet.

"You're overexerting yourself," Mydei says, not bothering to hide the disgust anymore.

Phainon tilts his head toward Mydei and glares. "Forgive me for taking responsibility for the whole of Okhema, for caring about the safety of the people trapped here—people that include refugees from your own land."

Mydei doesn't rise to his bait. "You've pulled something in your thigh," he says instead, "because you're working even when you should be resting. If you keep wearing your body down, you won't be able to protect yourself in a fight, never mind the whole of Okhema."

"A good warrior—"

"Knows when he should give his body a break." Mydei crosses his arms. "And that soaking an inflamed muscle in hot water isn't going to help him."

Phainon pulls away from the wall, no longer relaxed, sputtering. "I'm—"

"Not taking care of yourself the way you should," Mydei says. "An entire city state relies on you, and you're destroying yourself."

Phainon looks away. After a long, tense moment which Mydei does nothing to resolve, he grits out, "Then what would you recommend?"

"Get out of the bath," Mydei says, rising, too. He turns, picking up the towel near him and snaps it out of its folds. It falls gently to the tile. "Lay down."

"Why?" Phainon sounds suspicious, and when Mydei looks over at him, his eyes are narrowed and his brows drawn.

Rolling his eyes, Mydei says, "So I can rip your arms off and beat you with them, Deliverer." Phainon's eyes narrow even more. "Inflammation should be treated with cold." He flicks his finger against the edge of a copper bowl, still chilled. It clangs loudly in the quiet bath chamber. "But if your muscles have seized up, we'll need to work them loose, too. Lay down."

With obvious uncertainty, Phainon turns to the edge of the tub and levers himself out. Mydei certainly doesn't watch water sluice down his back, his sides, his ass. He pays no attention to how rivulets cut along Phainon's sculpted musculature, and he doesn't think about what those strong hips might feel like flexing between his legs. He never has—except in the depths of Curtain-Fall Hour, when the world is still and quiet if still uncharitably bright.

Phainon tracks around the edge of the tub, no shame in his nakedness, and eases down onto the towel with an obvious grimace. He favors his left leg, sparing it his own weight. He hesitates.

"On your stomach," Mydei says, fairly certain the problem isn't one of the muscles that cross the front of the thigh.

Flicking Mydei a look of immense irritation, Phainon obeys, folding his arms in front of him and resting his chin on one wrist. "What are we doing?"

"Making sure I'm not speaking in hyperbole," Mydei replies. He heaves himself out of the water, careful not to spill it over the ledge and soak his towel, and settles on the lip of the bath.

Arranged before him beside the bowl of fresh fruit is a collection of bathing oils, and he takes one bottle in hand. He uncaps it, pouring a generous amount into one palm as lavender scent blooms in the air. Phainon wrinkles his nose, but Mydei pays him no mind. Turning toward Phainon, Mydei rubs his hands together and then, slowly, giving Phainon plenty of warning, sets his hands on Phainon's thigh.

Phainon jumps, whipping his head around. Every muscle in his thigh pulls tight, but when Mydei doesn't move, he relaxes, just a little.

"I need to touch you," Mydei says dryly.

"Do you need to touch every inch of me?" Phainon snaps back.

"Believe me when I say that's the last thing on my mind." It's not. He'd run his hands over every inch of the vaunted Deliverer's body if given the chance, but he's no fool; the Flame-Chase Journey will see one or both of them in their graves soon enough. One day, despite Mydei's immortality, someone will get lucky in their strikes. If they're both going to be dead soon enough, and Phainon will die long before Mydei even if he survives the Journey, there's no point in—any of it. "Relax, Deliverer."

Phainon snorts. "How's that going to happen when your hands are five inches and one wrong move away from my dick?"

"I'm not interested in your dick," Mydei says, even though that's a lie. He is extremely interested in Phainon's dick and what Phainon could do with it. But, again, there's no point. Not when Phainon's life is a short blink that conflict will surely cut even shorter. "Relax."

Mydei doesn't move his hands, just keeps them still on the back and side of Phainon's thigh, until Phainon, with obvious reluctance, starts to relax. It's a slow process, progressing in fits

and bursts, but eventually Phainon's muscles uncoil.

"Now," Mydei says, pitching his voice low despite himself, "I'm going to do some poking and prodding to find out what's actually wrong. If anything hurts, tell me."

Staring straight ahead, Phainon just grunts in acknowledgement.

Mydei allows himself a quiet chuckle, shaking his head as he applies a gentle pressure to a line of Phainon's muscles with his thumb. Phainon tenses immediately, and Mydei turns his eyes heavenward, toward Kephale, as if the Titan will answer his prayers.

"I can't do this if you're tense." And he wonders what precisely has Phainon tensing—maybe it's Mydei himself, but Mydei expects they're past most of their bullshit by now. He doesn't have to like Phainon to have his back, and it's insulting that Phainon might be on guard because he doesn't share that sentiment. "I'm not going to put a blade in your back," Mydei says with bitter irony.

"I know that," Phainon snaps, shaking himself and relaxing once more. He still doesn't look at Mydei. "This is just—weird."

"Hm." Mydei presses his thumb into Phainon's muscles again, following that same line as before.

This time, Phainon doesn't tense, but he does say, "We're on the same side, but it's not as if you treat me like a friend." Mydei does, in fact, treat Phainon like a friend, but their expectations for friendship are clearly very, very different. "And now we're naked, in the baths, and you've got your hands half an inch from my dick."

"Are you always so preoccupied with the proximity of my hands to your dick?" Mydei asks. Phainon makes the same sort of sound you'd hear from a wet cat. Mydei choses to ignore it. "I'm not going to touch you anywhere but your leg." Even though he wants to. Even though he's wanted to for quite a long time. But Phainon is Okhema's darling Deliverer, and Mydei is the discarded prince of a fallen kingdom that shouldn't be revived.

"Fine, then," Phainon grumbles.

Mydei continues his work, gently probing Phainon's leg for damage, seeking out areas of tension. When he finds them, he soothes them with long, slow strokes of his thumb, pressing deep to release that tension.

A startled noise squeaks out of Phainon, but when he makes no remark, Mydei ignores it in favor of working.

"Here," he says, digging his thumb a little deeper into one of the muscles along the back of Phainon's thigh. Phainon makes the kind of sound Mydei has imagined when alone in his bed, the kind of sound Mydei has dreamed of hearing. Steadying his own breathing, he continues. "It's tight and overworked, probably strained. I can help ease the tension here and in the muscles around it." His fingers don't move.

After a long silence, Phainon says, “Since when are you a doctor?”

“Every warrior knows battlefield triage and how to assess the damage that impedes one’s ability to fight,” Mydei replies, offhanded, and only after does he realize Phainon might not have that same experience. “It’s the difference between life and death, knowing your bodies limits.”

“Well,” Phainon says, slapping his hands against the tile as though he means to rise. “We can’t all be the mighty Mydeimos, knowledgeable about all things combat.”

Mydei puts his elbow in Phainon’s back, shoving him back down to the floor. “If you get up that way, you’re going to make it worse.”

All the air explodes out of Phainon as he hits the ground, and he whips his head over his shoulder to fix Mydei with a fierce scowl. “I—”

“Do you want my help or not?”

Phainon presses his lips into a flat line before slowly, oh so slowly, turning away from Mydei again. He doesn’t move, just lies there, waiting.

Taking that as tacit permission, Mydei returns his hands to Phainon’s thigh and gets to work. He works his thumbs into knots and areas of tension, pulling gently on the muscles by dragging the heel of his hand across them. Slow and methodical, he spends his time in the places that need his attention, and though he tries to keep his touch clinical, he finds he can’t. He lingers, and it’s so hard not to imagine his shoulders between those thighs, one of them maybe on *his* shoulder, as he sucks Phainon’s cock down his throat. He wants to make Phainon gasp, wants to hear him moan, wants to hear his own name on Phainon’s lips like a war cry.

None of that is possible, of course. He is keenly aware of his own position in the world, of what everyone around him thinks of him. They despise him, revile him, and revere him in equal measure, and only Phainon has shown him the crumbs of decency and respect, but it’s not what he wants.

He’s used to wanting impossible things.

His hands move lower, closer to Phainon’s knee and then beneath it, testing the muscles of his calf. They’re looser, but still tight from compensating for the pull in his thigh, so Mydei works them, too. And he pretends not to hear the hitching of Phainon’s breath, pretends not to feel the tremble in Phainon’s body.

“Almost done,” he murmurs, as though the moment is fragile.

“Whatever you need to do,” Phainon replies, glib, yes, but just as quiet.

A strange tension fills the air as Mydei works, and he’s acutely aware of it pressing down around him. He breathes it in, and it fills his lungs, clogs them, and he doesn’t know what to do about it. As a warrior, he’s a man of action, but he doesn’t know how to act in this

moment except to continue massaging Phainon's leg long past the point he should be done. He sweeps his hands back up, digging his thumbs into Phainon's thigh, and he can't help himself.

His palm slides up the outside of Phainon's leg, pressing into the meat of his ass from the side. "Here," he says, turning to watch Phainon's scant profile. "This muscle is tense, too."

Phainon swallows audibly. "Whatever you need to do," he says again.

Mydei pushes his knuckles carefully into that tension and then smooths it away with long strokes of his palm. His fingers itch to run higher, over Phainon's sides, to drift between his legs to flirt with what he might find of Phainon's cock, but he holds himself back, telling himself he must be content with this. He'll almost certainly never touch Phainon again, and even this is something of a dream, ephemeral and fleeting.

Flicking his eyes to the small of Phainon's back, he wonders. Wonders if he should take the risk, if he should ask for more, if he dares to be so bold. Conquering land is easy, winning battles is simple. Taking a man is much harder.

"There will be tension in your back," he says.

Phainon has lowered his forehead to rest against his wrist. "Whatever you need to do," he says a third time.

Mydei smooths his hands over Phainon's flank, his ass, a bold and sensual caress that has everything to do with his own desires and nothing to do with helping Phainon. Perhaps it's wrong for him to take advantage, to view this as something sensual when Phainon surely doesn't, but at least in this he is weak. Pathetic. There should be no words for this in the Kremnoan language, and he should be ashamed, but there is no shame in taking every advantage that doesn't take *too much* advantage.

This, he must remember, is not a seduction. And even if it was, he wouldn't know the first way to go about it. He's never seduced anyone before. He's never had to. Others have fallen easily into his bed at the first sign of his interest, but Phainon is, as ever, an outlier in Mydei's life. Maybe that's why he's so fascinating. Or maybe it's the optimism, the youthful certainty that he can take on the world and emerge victorious. Phainon has lost much, yes, but those losses drive him differently than Mydei's losses drive him.

"Mydei?"

His hands are still on Phainon's back, and he grimaces. Once more, he moves his hands in sweeping strokes over Phainon's body. "Wool gathering," he supplies. "You're lucky. I don't feel inflammation, only the tension of overworked muscles. You shouldn't practice tomorrow."

"But—"

"A warrior must know when to rest his body. You can't afford to push yourself to the breaking point." A breath. "Deliverer."

“I have a name.”

Mydei doesn’t trust himself to use it. “So you do.” His thumbs dig into the small of Phainon’s back, to either side of his spine, and Phainon gasps. Groans. Stretches like a cat beneath Mydei’s hands, and the sounds and sight goes straight to Mydei’s dick. It stirs between his legs, twitching with interest. He wills it down, trying to keep his focus on what he’s doing, but what he’s doing is putting his hands all over Phainon’s naked, sculpted body.

He withdraws.

“That should help.” He reaches for the bowl of fruit, plucking a grape from its depths and popping it into his mouth. “You can go, if you’d like.”

But Phainon doesn’t move, and when Mydei turns toward him, he finds that Phainon has buried his face in his hands against the ground. He says something, too, but it’s muffled and faint, and Mydei can’t discern the words.

“What?”

Phainon removes one hand from his face, which is flaming red. “I said, I can’t.”

Hunger surges through Mydei, sudden and fierce. “And why is that?” he asks, his throat dry, his tongue too big for his mouth. But he knows. It’s the same reason he planned to slide back into the bathwater the minute Phainon moved.

One brilliantly blue eye meets his briefly before flicking away. Phainon groans.

Mydei’s breath catches in his throat. He’s never navigated a shy partner before, has never been the seducer, has never needed to be. Reaching out, he settles his hand on the small of Phainon’s back, rubbing his thumb in a slow, small circle over Phainon’s spine.

Phainon groans again, burying his face in the towel beneath him.

“Roll over,” Mydei says.

Phainon shakes his head. “Are you—Are you out of your mind?”

“We’re alone, Deliverer,” Mydei says, as gently as he’s ever said anything, keenly aware of the increasing fragility of this particular moment.

“So there’s no one to see my shame?”

“Nor mine.”

Phainon looks once more to Mydei, turning his face toward him, and Mydei reaches between his thighs, making a show of pulling his hand over his half-hard cock. His thigh certainly blocks the view, but the gesture is plain enough; Phainon’s eyes widen, his body going stiff.

“And there,” Mydei says. “You’ve ruined all my hard work.”

Phainon swallows, lifting his eyes to Mydei's. "Not all of it."

"Then roll over."

Slowly, moving as though he will break the air around him, Phainon rolls to his back, revealing a hard cock arching over his stomach, the tip sticking with precum. He is red-tipped and thick, longer than Mydei imagined, and Mydei reaches for him, his eyes on Phainon's. Phainon doesn't look away as Mydei closes his hand around Phainon's cock, stroking from the base to just beneath the head.

Even when Phainon's back bows and his lips part on a silent groan, he doesn't look away.

They watch each other as Mydei maps the length of Phainon's cock with callused fingertips, as he strokes those fingers over the head to smear precum into Phainon's skin. They watch each other as Mydei runs his fingers back down Phainon's length, as he begins a slow and even rhythm.

"Is this happening?" Phainon asks, with the wonder of a man who has dreamed of something for a long, long time.

"Yes," Mydei manages, but he says nothing else, the words all stuck in his throat.

Beneath his hand, Phainon's skin is like silk, his cock like tempered steel; he is sizeable, and muscles in Mydei's abdomen clench at the thought of that cock inside him, carving into him, pushing through his body to make a home for itself. He'd welcome it—and, perhaps, so would Phainon.

He rubs his palm over the head of Phainon's cock, smearing precum into his skin to make its passing easier when he strokes the length of it again, again. His breath shudders through him as he finds a rhythm that Phainon likes, that has Phainon's hips rolling into his fist. And with his free hand, he squeezes himself, aware of a building pleasure at the base of his spine but not particularly concerned with it.

No, his focus is squarely on Phainon, on the expression of pleasure washing over Phainon's face, on the way Phainon's eyes drift shut and his lips part and his back bows. One of his hands drives into his own hair, and the other clutches at the towel beneath him as his hips snap and roll. Heavier and heavier breaths punch out of his chest, and Mydei is certain from the fracturing rhythm of them that Phainon is close.

Until, abruptly, Phainon grabs Mydei's wrist and shoots upright. "Not like this," he says, grabbing the hair at the back of Mydei's head and dragging him into a kiss that is demanding and fierce.

Mydei gasps, floored—but, perhaps, less floored now than he might have been five minutes ago. Phainon's earlier words *were* spoken by a wanting man, a man who desires, and now Phainon slicks his tongue into Mydei's mouth, taking what he wants like a warrior should. Mydei resists—it's not in him to simply roll over for anyone, even someone he's lusted after for as long as he has Phainon—pushing his tongue against Phainon's own, forcing Phainon to take more, to demand more, to make Mydei submit. The submission is *good*, the relenting to

someone else, even if for just a moment, is exquisite, is as close to something divine as Mydei thinks he'll ever come.

But that's not entirely true. He wouldn't allow this with just anyone. Everyone else, he would power over—he has powered over—but Phainon is—Phainon is the golden hero on the hill, bathed in sunlight, awash in power. He is something Mydei cannot ever be, and Mydei doesn't resent that; he wants to be at the feet of that.

Phainon gains his knees, kneeling over Mydei, and Mydei groans as Phainon pulls his head back, forcing him to accept a hungrier kiss, a deeper kiss. Their tongues push against each other, a tangle of muscle that Phainon eventually wins, and Mydei moans into Phainon's mouth. Pain from the tugging on his hair lances down his spine to settle in his cock, thick and full and hard now, and he releases himself to grip Phainon's waist.

They break apart, Phainon staring down at Mydei, panting, his eyes bright with lust. "You…"

"If not with my hand, then how?" Mydei asks, leaning back. He goes to one elbow, reclining half on the towel he laid out for Phainon, letting his legs spread wide for Phainon to see all of him, and Phainon rakes his gaze down the length of his body with hungry eyes. "Tell me."

Panting, Phainon drags his eyes back to Mydei's. "I—I want to be inside you," he says.

Mydei lets his head fall back. He gives Phainon his throat because Phainon will understand that, and he reaches between his legs with a hand still slick with oil. His wrist brushes his cock as his fingers travel lower, lower, flirting with his hole, only for Phainon to seize his wrist once more.

"Let me," Phainon says, fierce but not overeager, hungry but not demanding. "I—I mean—"

Mydei scoffs. "Be bold, Deliverer, and take what you want."

"Only if you want it, too," Phainon says.

At that, Mydei laughs. "Here I am, laying myself before you, and you're asking if I want it, too. What a strange man you are, Phainon of Aedes Elysiae."

Phainon's lips part, his eyes blowing wide. "You never say my name."

"I do," Mydei does, but it's a rare thing.

Phainon surges forward, capturing Mydei's mouth with his once more. He rests one hand on Mydei's shoulder lightly before putting his weight behind it, before bearing Mydei the rest of the way down. Mydei goes, settling his hands on Phainon's hips as Phainon hovers above him, braced on one arm, as their tongues once more meet in wicked thrusts that are so much like sex Mydei's cock aches with need. He arches beneath Phainon, trying to grind their bodies together, but Phainon remains just out of reach.

Breaking away from their kiss, Phainon catches Mydei's lower lip in his teeth, applying just enough pressure for it to sting, for it to feel exquisite. "Let me," he says again, forceful this time, and Mydei groans.

There's the clatter of a bottle of oil falling over, and now Mydei laughs, amused. Phainon is all puppy eager, fumbling what they need, and Mydei is surprised to find it more endearing than the practiced seductions of those who came before. None of them matter compared to Phainon.

He spills oil over his fingers, dripping it onto Mydei's chest and stomach as he brings his hand between their bodies, as he presses those fingers against Mydei's hole. He licks his lips, and Mydei reads the uncertainty in him. Not the uncertainty of complete inexperience, he doesn't think, but that of being unsure how to please a new partner.

"One," Mydei says, reaching down to press his fingers against one of Phainon's own, urging it to push harder against his hole. He groans, arching into that touch, more than eager to feel Phainon inside him, but it's been a small age since he last laid with someone, and he wants to savor this moment. Even now, it feels unreal, and he's half afraid he'll wake from this dream at any moment.

Phainon rubs his finger across the tight furl of Mydei's hole, slow and lingering caresses. Each revolution pulls a shudder of pleasure through Mydei's body, and his cock twitches, dripping precum onto his stomach.

"More," he says. "I'm not fragile."

Phainon's eyes flick up to his. "Do you like it rough?"

No one's ever asked him that before. They've been eager to please, certainly, but no one has ever asked him how he wants to get fucked, and the question catches him utterly by surprise. Usually, his partners are too wrapped up in the splendor of being in the son of Gorgo's bed, and they have little interest in more than those honors. But Phainon—Phainon doesn't care about bedding the prince of Castrum Kremnos. Phainon doesn't even want Mydeimos. He wants *Mydei*.

"Not at first," Mydei says. "But I want you inside me too much right now."

Revelation flashes in Phainon's eyes, realization. Mydei has overplayed his hand, but instead of mocking him for it, Phainon bends down and seizes his mouth in a brutal kiss, a hungry kiss, a warrior's kiss. It's fierce and fiery, demanding and relentless, and as their tongues tangle together, Phainon glides his finger into Mydei's body.

Mydei groans into their kiss, running one hand up Phainon's body to clutch at his shoulder. The other drifts to Phainon's cock. He wraps his fingers around Phainon's length, stroking slowly, lazily. Phainon takes his rhythm, fucking his finger slowly into Mydei's body at the same, indolent pace, as if they're not fucking in the public baths, where anyone could find them. But it's late, and the city is largely asleep, the baths abandoned except for the two of them, lost in each other.

One finger becomes two, and Mydei pulls away from their kiss to gasp at the aching stretch, the wonderful burn of fingers inside him. It's just to one side of painful, the perfect blending of pleasure and mild discomfort, a wicked stretch that has him panting as Phainon begins to work him open in earnest.

Above him, Phainon rests his head on Mydei's forehead. "So tight," he breathes. "You're so tight for me, Mydei. You feel so *hot*, so good. I can't wait to get inside you, to feel you around my cock. You're going to be so good for me, I know you are." He babbles as he fucks his fingers into Mydei's body, and Mydei can't help the ghost of a laugh that spills past his lips. Of course Phainon would be a talker, but he doesn't mind at all. The casual praise is far more genuine than anything he's received in the past, and he revels in it. In Phainon, in his touch, his petting caresses, the weight of his cock in Mydei's own hand. "Feel so good, you feel so good, your tight rim squeezing around me, your hand around my cock." He pants, his breath hot on Mydei's lips.

"Next time," Mydei says, "we'll fuck our cocks together until you come on my stomach."

Phainon swears a wicked oath, freezing. He shudders, gritting his teeth, and then snarls softly. "You can't *say* things like that."

Mydei turns his lips to Phainon's ear. "Then fuck me now, Deliverer. Fill me up with your cock until I can't breathe around it."

"You—You can't be ready."

Mydei bites on Phainon's earlobe, pulling a shudder through Phainon's body. "Fuck me, Phainon of Aedes Elysiae."

And that must be what Phainon needed to hear, because he pulls his fingers out of Mydei's body with a sudden urgency, slicking down his cock with the remains of the oil. He pushes the head of his cock against Mydei's hole, and Mydei lets his head fall back, lets Phainon have the fragile column of his throat as he moans. Pressure, fullness, the stretch of his body around a cock he isn't fully prepared to take but desperately needs to have inside of him. He clenches around Phainon's cock, squeezing as it glides deeper, and Phainon slowly lowers himself over Mydei's body until they're chest to chest, stomach to stomach.

His arms bracket Mydei's head as he presses deeper, sliding in to the hilt, grinding himself into Mydei's ass. His mouth finds Mydei's throat, pressing a suckling kiss to the skin there, and Mydei moans, smoothing his hands down Phainon's back to fill his palms with Phainon's ass.

"More," he croons, and Phainon gives.

Braced above Mydei, he starts a slow and languid pace, every thrust of his hips gliding his stomach against Mydei's too-hard cock. The friction is exquisite, it's mind numbing, it's almost as good as the stretching fullness of Phainon's cock inside him.

"More," he says again, and Phainon dips his head to Mydei's chest, biting at his throat, his collarbone. He picks up his pace, fucking harder into Mydei's body, every thrust jostling him against the tile and the towel. "I'm not fragile." The reminder isn't necessarily a complaint, but he—

"Let me be good to you," Phainon murmurs into Mydei's throat.

Something twists in Mydei's chest, and for a moment he wonders if he hasn't been stabbed. But Phainon's fingers are tangled in his hair, and Phainon's mouth is hot on his neck, and Phainon's cock is deep inside him, carving into him, fucking over his prostate with every thrust.

"So tight," Phainon continues, oblivious. "So hot and tight around me. Mydei, Mydei, you feel so *good*, like you were made to fit me." Again, Phainon babbles, spilling out so much earnest praise that Mydei can't take it, that he wants to turn away, turn over, to hide his face from the man above him. But then Phainon's fingers are coaxing their lips together for another kiss, long and lingering, as his thrusts grow harder, faster. One of his hands drops to Mydei's hip, urging one of his legs over Phainon's waist so he can fuck deeper into Mydei's body, and Mydei moans hungrily into their kiss.

This one, though, is no battle: it's a meeting of equals trading equal pleasure. It's a give and take, a dance like a spar, each of them anticipating what the other wants. Phainon licks into Mydei's mouth before retreating, letting Mydei taste him in turn, a push-pull that has Mydei half drunk on it. Never in his life has he met a bed partner as an equal, and this is—it's a revelation, but only because it's Phainon moving over him, above him, against him. Only because it's Phainon that he grinds into when he rolls his hips to take more. Only because it's Phainon inside him.

"Want you to feel so good, too," Phainon murmurs between their kisses. "Want to make you feel so, *so* good." He shifts, reaching between them, wrapping his hand around Mydei's aching cock, and Mydei claps a hand over his mouth to keep from crying out.

He's so hard he hurts, is desperate to come, and Phainon's hand on him is making that increasingly likely. Working himself into Phainon's hand, grinding himself onto Phainon's cock, he loses himself in the pleasure of it, lets himself fall away. He abandons his title, his history, the weight on his shoulders and just, for a moment, lets himself be Mydei instead of Mydeimos, son of Gorgo.

"Mydei," Phainon groans. "Mydei, Mydei." He chants Mydei's name like it's a prayer, like it's a benediction, like this alone will push back the black tide and cure the Titans of their madness. Like Mydei is a Titan himself, set above all others, deserving of praise, and for the first time in his life, Mydei welcomes it because it isn't about him, it's about Phainon.

He drives his fingers into Phainon's hair, pulling him back to his lips for a voracious kiss, for something hungry and all consuming, devouring and demanding. Phainon groans, stroking him harder, fucking him faster, finding the perfect rhythm, and Mydei moans, clinging to Phainon's hair, his shoulder. He wraps his leg high around Phainon's waist, his heel digging into Phainon's back as pleasure grows and grows within him, as it blooms into something fierce and beautiful that eclipses reason.

And when he comes, it's sweet agony, it's him pouring himself onto his stomach and Phainon's as his ass clenches and squeezes around Phainon's cock, as Phainon cries out into their shared kiss before he, too, loses himself inside Mydei's body.

It's ecstasy, this shared pleasure, knowing that they've both found completion in each other. Mydei clings to Phainon, shuddering, groaning. His nails bite into Phainon's shoulders as

pleasure continues to shudder through him in residual pulses and echoes. Slowly, it fades, and as it does, Phainon breaks their kiss to once more rest his forehead against Mydei's.

They pant together, wrapped around each other at the far end of the baths, entwined in an intimate embrace that, hopefully, no one has seen.

"Mydei," Phainon breathes.

Mydei opens his eyes, meeting Phainon's glassy gaze. He weighs two names in his mouth, letting them tumble over his tongue, before he says, "Phainon."

Slowly, gently, Phainon eases out of him. He eases onto his side next to Mydei and hesitantly places his hand on Mydei's sticky abdomen. "That was…" He licks his lips—and Mydei sees it, the hint of pain in his eyes.

"It was good, but we strained your leg more than necessary," Mydei surmises.

Phainon shakes his head, snatching his hand back as though burned. "No, no, I'm—"

"Do not lie to me, Deliverer. What have I told you all evening?"

Phainon heaves out a heavy sigh. "A warrior knows when to rest."

"He does. Come, get in the water to clean up, and then I'll walk you to your room." Mydei rolls into the water. "And if you're lucky, while you're resting, we will find other, creative ways to enjoy each other's company."

At that, Phainon perks up, just like an overeager puppy, and Mydei allows himself a small, tiny smile as he gives Phainon his back.

End Notes

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